

D760

Secondary Literacy and Mathematics Strategies and Assistive Technologies

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A 16-year-old with a learning disability wants to work in auto repair. He runs on the track team and his grandfather owns a farm. Which is a measurable postsecondary goal?

- A. He will explore careers in the automotive field.
- B. After graduation, he will work on his grandfather's farm.
- C. After graduation, he will enroll in an automotive technology certificate program at a community college.
- D. He will pass his junior-year English class with a C or better.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Under IDEA, by when must a student's IEP first include measurable postsecondary goals and transition services?

- A. Only when the parent requests it.
- B. The IEP in effect when the student turns 16, or earlier if appropriate.
- C. The IEP in effect when the student turns 18.
- D. Only in the student's final year of school.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

An IEP team meets for a 15-year-old with autism. His mother hopes he will become an accountant because he is good with numbers, and the meeting is held in the library after school. What should the team do before writing his postsecondary goals?

- A. Write an accounting goal because he is good with numbers.
- B. Give age-appropriate transition assessments, such as interest inventories and interviews with him, to learn his preferences and strengths.
- C. Use his IQ score alone to pick a career.
- D. Wait until he is 18 so he can decide on his own.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A tenth grader with ADHD takes chemistry tests in a separate quiet room. The chemistry teacher has taught for 20 years and uses an interactive whiteboard. Which accommodation category is the separate room?

- A. Presentation
- B. Setting
- C. Timing and scheduling
- D. Modification

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student's IEP lets her answer test questions orally into a recorder instead of writing. Which category is this?

- A. Presentation
- B. Timing and scheduling
- C. Setting
- D. Response

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A ninth-grade biology unit covers cell parts. Students with learning disabilities can define each part but cannot explain how the parts work together. The school just upgraded its microscopes, and the unit lasts three weeks. What should the co-teachers add?

- A. An advance organizer at the start and a graphic organizer showing how the parts connect, used through the unit.
- B. Extra lab time on the new microscopes.
- C. A graphic organizer handed out only after the unit test.
- D. More flashcards of cell-part definitions.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

An eleventh grader with a learning disability gets computation right but sets up most algebra word problems wrong. She works part-time at a grocery store and is in the school choir. Which intervention fits best?

- A. Give her the equations and have her solve them.
- B. Use only grocery-store word problems.
- C. Timed computation drills to boost speed.
- D. Teach a routine to read, paraphrase, visualize, plan, estimate, compute, and check, with say-ask-check self-talk at each step.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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8.

A twelfth grader with dysgraphia tried a smartpen for note-taking for six weeks. His quiz scores stayed at 60% with and without it. He says he loves the pen, and it cost the school \$180. What should the team decide?

- A. Keep the pen because he loves it.
- B. Keep the pen because it was expensive.
- C. Remove all note-taking supports permanently.
- D. Review why it did not help and trial a different support, since data show no gain.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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9.

A ninth grader's math problem-solving probe score was 12 points in week 2 and 28 points in week 10. The teacher changed seats in week 6 and the class got a new textbook in week 8. What is the student's rate of improvement?

- A. 16 points per week
- B. 8 points per week
- C. 2 points per week
- D. 2.8 points per week

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student scores 28 on a probe now and is growing 2 points per week. The IEP goal is 40. At this rate, about how many more weeks until she reaches the goal?

- A.** 6 weeks
- B.** 12 weeks
- C.** 24 weeks
- D.** 20 weeks

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A special education teacher leads a small group of tenth graders reading an article about a town's new recycling rule. The article is four pages long and includes two photographs. Which question best builds critical thinking?

- A.** When did the recycling rule start?
- B.** List every fact in the article.
- C.** Which of the author's reasons is strongest, and what evidence supports your choice?
- D.** What is shown in the two photographs?

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher asks, "Name the three branches of government." She wants to raise this to an analysis-level question on the same topic. Which works?

- A.** How does each branch limit the power of the others?
- B.** Name all 50 state capitals.
- C.** Define the word "branch."
- D.** Name the three branches and spell them correctly.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A 16-year-old with a learning disability wants to work in auto repair. ~~He runs on the track team and his grandfather owns a farm.~~ Which is a measurable postsecondary goal?

Target word: which goal is measurable and post-school **Decides:** Must name an observable outcome after high school.

A	Dropped element	No measurable outcome or post-school time frame.
B	Camouflage	Uses the farm detail; it ignores his stated interest in auto repair.
C	Correct	Names a specific, countable outcome that occurs after high school.
D	Adjacent category	That is an annual goal during high school, not a postsecondary goal.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

Under IDEA, by when must a student's IEP first include measurable postsecondary goals and transition services?

Target word: timing of transition requirements **Decides:** The IEP in effect when the student turns 16, or younger if the team or state requires.

A	Adjacent category	Transition planning is required, not optional on request.
B	Correct	This is the federal floor; many states start at 14.
C	Confusion set	18 is typical age of majority, not the start of transition planning.
D	Absolute language	Transition planning must start years before exit.

3. Answer B Concept 2

An IEP team meets for a 15-year-old with autism. His mother hopes he will become an accountant because he is good with numbers, ~~and the meeting is held in the library after school.~~ What should the team do before writing his postsecondary goals?

Target word: basis for transition goals **Decides:** Goals must rest on transition assessment of the student.

A	Dropped element	Skips the student's own preferences and any assessment.
B	Correct	Goals must be based on assessed strengths, preferences, interests, and needs.
C	Adjacent category	A single cognitive score is not a transition assessment of interests and preferences.
D	Wrong stem number	Transition planning must begin by 16, not wait until 18.

4. Answer B Concept 3

A tenth grader with ADHD takes chemistry tests in a separate quiet room. ~~The chemistry teacher has taught for 20 years and uses an interactive whiteboard.~~ Which accommodation category is the separate room?

Target word: classify the accommodation **Decides:** Where the student tests = setting.

A	Camouflage	The whiteboard detail suggests how content is shown; the room is about location.
B	Correct	A change in location is a setting accommodation.
C	Confusion set	Timing is about when and how long, not where.
D	Adjacent category	A modification changes what is learned; the room does not.

5. Answer D Concept 3 · transfer

A student's IEP lets her answer test questions orally into a recorder instead of writing. Which category is this?

Target word: classify the accommodation **Decides:** How the student answers = response.

A	Inverted operation	Presentation changes how information reaches the student, the opposite direction.
B	Confusion set	Nothing about time changes.
C	Confusion set	Nothing about location changes.
D	Correct	Changing how a student shows answers is a response accommodation.

6. Answer A Concept 4

A ninth-grade biology unit covers cell parts. Students with learning disabilities can define each part but cannot explain how the parts work together. ~~The school just upgraded its microscopes, and the unit lasts three weeks.~~ What should the co-teachers add?

Target word: support for seeing relationships among ideas **Decides:** Students know details but not structure.

A	Correct	Organizers make relationships among concepts visible and link new ideas.
B	Camouflage	The microscopes do not address understanding how parts relate.
C	Inverted operation	Organizers help most before and during learning.
D	Dropped element	Builds the definitions they already know, not the connections.

7. Answer D Concept 5

An eleventh grader with a learning disability gets computation right but sets up most algebra word problems wrong. ~~She works part time at a grocery store and is in the school choir.~~ Which intervention fits best?

Target word: fix for problem-solving setup **Decides:** The gap is setup, not calculation.

A	Dropped element	Removes the setup skill she needs to learn.
B	Camouflage	Context may engage her but does not teach a setup routine.
C	Adjacent category	Her computation is already accurate.
D	Correct	A cognitive-metacognitive routine targets setup and self-monitoring.

8. Answer D Concept 6

A twelfth grader with dysgraphia tried a smartpen for note-taking for six weeks. His quiz scores stayed at 60% with and without it. ~~He says he loves the pen, and it cost the school \$180.~~ What should the team decide?

Target word: AT decision from data **Decides:** No gain in performance with the tool.

A	Camouflage	Preference matters but does not outweigh flat data.
B	Camouflage	Cost already spent does not decide fit.
C	Absolute language	One failed tool does not mean no support will work.
D	Correct	AT is judged by performance data; no change means the fit needs rethinking.

9. Answer C Concept 7

A ninth grader's math problem-solving probe score was 12 points in week 2 and 28 points in week 10. ~~The teacher changed seats in week 6 and the class got a new textbook in week 8.~~ What is the student's rate of improvement?

Target word: weekly growth **Decides:** $(28 - 12) / (10 - 2) = 2$.

A	Wrong stem number	Total gain, not per week.
B	Camouflage	Uses the week-6 and week-8 events instead of the score change.
C	Correct	16 points gained over 8 weeks = 2 per week.
D	Dropped element	28 / 10 ignores the starting score and week.

10. Answer A Concept 7 · transfer

A student scores 28 on a probe now and is growing 2 points per week. The IEP goal is 40. At this rate, about how many more weeks until she reaches the goal?

Target word: solve for weeks **Decides:** $(40 - 28) / 2 = 6$.

A	Correct	12 points needed at 2 per week.
B	Wrong stem number	Points needed, not weeks.
C	Inverted operation	Multiplies 12 by 2 instead of dividing.
D	Dropped element	40 / 2 ignores the current score.

11. Answer C Concept 8

A special education teacher leads a small group of tenth graders reading an article about a town's new recycling rule. ~~The article is four pages long and includes two photographs.~~ Which question best builds critical thinking?

Target word: higher-order question **Decides:** Evaluate: judging an argument with evidence.

A	Adjacent category	Recall of a fact.
B	Confusion set	Long recall is still recall, not higher-order thinking.
C	Correct	Asks students to evaluate and justify, a higher-order task.
D	Camouflage	Describes the photos; recall, not analysis.

12. Answer A Concept 8 · transfer

A teacher asks, "Name the three branches of government." She wants to raise this to an analysis-level question on the same topic. Which works?

Target word: raise a recall question to analysis **Decides:** Analysis = examine relationships or parts.

A	Correct	Asks students to examine relationships among parts: analysis.
B	Absolute language	A bigger recall task is not higher-order.
C	Inverted operation	Moves down to simpler recall.
D	Dropped element	Still recall, with spelling added.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	7	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	3	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	4	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	8	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Measurable postsecondary goals	Starting with the IEP in effect when the student turns 16 (earlier in some states), the IEP must include measurable goals for after high school in training or education and employment, and independent living where appropriate.	Writing vague hopes (“will explore careers”) or goals for what happens during high school.	“After graduation, the student will...”
2	Transition assessment drives goals	Postsecondary goals must rest on age-appropriate transition assessments of the student’s strengths, preferences, interests, and needs.	Writing transition goals from what the parents or teacher want without asking or assessing the student.	A team drafts transition goals before any interest or skill inventory.
3	Four accommodation categories	Accommodations change presentation (how information is given), response (how the student answers), setting (where), or timing and scheduling (when and how long), without changing what is learned.	Calling extended time a response accommodation or read-aloud a setting accommodation.	A list of supports to sort by type.
4	Advance and graphic organizers	Showing how new content is structured before and during a lesson helps students link ideas and remember them.	Using organizers only as after-the-fact worksheets.	Students cannot see how the details of a unit fit together.
5	Cognitive-metacognitive math routine	Routines like read, paraphrase, visualize, hypothesize, estimate, compute, check, paired with say–ask–check self-talk, improve problem solving for students with LD.	Teaching faster computation to fix weak problem solving.	A student computes well but cannot set up word problems.
6	Judging AT with data	Keep, change, or drop an assistive technology based on the student’s performance data during a trial, not on preference or popularity.	Keeping a tool because the student likes it or because it cost a lot.	Before-and-after performance numbers with and without a tool.
7	Rate of improvement	Rate of improvement = (later score – earlier score) / weeks between them; compare it with the rate needed to reach the IEP goal.	Dividing the later score by the number of weeks.	Two dated scores and a question about weekly growth.
8	Higher-order questioning	Questions that ask students to analyze, evaluate, or create push critical thinking beyond recall.	Assuming harder facts to recall are higher-order questions.	A teacher wants students to think critically about a text or solution.

Course scope (public description): Secondary Literacy and Mathematics Strategies and Assistive Technologies prepares special education teachers to use progress monitoring and evidence-based instructional practices appropriate for use with secondary students with exceptionalities. This course focuses on intensive instruction and accommodation that includes assistive technology to secondary lesson plans. Learners will apply strategies to

develop student critical thinking and problem-solving skills. Learners will assess and measure student progress towards the Individualized Education Program (IEP) and transition goals for post-secondary and career preparation.